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Unit 1

Vedic Culture in North India and Megalithic Culture in South India



Learning Objectives

- To know the origin and migration of Aryans into India.
- To identify the sources of study relating to the Vedic Age.
- To understand the evolution of political, economic and the religious structures in Rig Vedic and Later Vedic Societies.
- To locate the regions inhabited by both early and later Vedic people.
- To make the differences between early and later Vedic periods.
- To understand the Megalithic/Iron Age culture in Tamil Nadu.

Vedic Age

The first phase of urbanisation in India came to an end with the decline of Indus Civilisation. A new era, called Vedic Age began with the arrival of Aryans.

Vedic Age – It is a period in the History of India between 1500 BC (BCE) – 600 BC (BCE). It gets its name from four 'Vedas'

Who were the Aryans?

The Aryans were Indo–Aryan language speaking, semi nomadic pastoralists. They came from Central Asia in several waves of migration through Khyber Pass of Hindu Kush Mountains.

Though cattle rearing was their main occupation, they also practised slash and burn agriculture.

DO YOU KNOW?

Slash and burn agriculture - It is a farming method that involves clearing the land by cutting and burning all the trees and plants on it. Cultivation is done there for a short time and then abandoned. People then move to a new piece of land for cultivation.

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